

Red Ranger

The film that starts the Morphin Grid Universe. It plays the role *Iron Man* played for Marvel.

Field	Detail
Release date	Friday, August 23, 2013, the weekend before the 20th anniversary of MMPR's August 28, 1993 premiere
Distributor	20th Century Fox
Rating / runtime	PG-13 / 155 minutes
Real title	Red Ranger
Decoy title	Coastal Drift
Whose film it is	Jason Lee Scott, the Red Ranger. The film launches his line and the Mighty Morphin Power Rangers franchise.

01 • TITLE: REAL AND DECOY

Red Ranger, shot as Coastal Drift

- **Real title:** *Red Ranger*. Simple and iconic, it's named after the hero the way *Iron Man* was.
- **Decoy title:** *Coastal Drift*. It reads like a Southern California teen surf drama, which explains teenage actors, beach and high school locations, and a martial arts gym, without hinting at Power Rangers. It goes on every call sheet, permit, trailer and crew shirt.

02 • WHOSE FILM IT IS

Jason Lee Scott, the Red Ranger

- The film is Jason's: his origin, his point of view and his arc. It opens his solo line and the Mighty Morphin Power Rangers franchise.
- **Faithfulness lock:** in canon, Zordon recruits all five Rangers together in *Day of the Dumpster*. Zack, Billy, Trini and Kimberly are recruited alongside Jason and play full supporting roles. No Ranger gets cut or downplayed to make this a solo movie. Jason is the lead and the others fight beside him, the way Tony Stark had Rhodey and Pepper.

03 • WHEN AND WHERE IT'S SET

MGU Year One: summer 2013, Angel Grove

- **Prologue, 10,000 years ago:** Zordon seals Rita Repulsa in a space dumpster and ends up trapped in a time warp himself.
- **Main story, summer 2013 (MGU Year One):** the present day, the same way the show was set in its own present. This is the first entry on the MGU master timeline.
- **Settings:** Angel Grove, California (Angel Grove High, the Youth Center and Ernie's Juice Bar); the Command Center in the desert outside town; and Rita's palace on the Moon.

04 • WHAT IT'S ABOUT

A leader is made.

- Astronauts on the Moon open a strange container, and Rita Repulsa is free after 10,000 years, set on conquering Earth. In Angel Grove, Zordon tells Alpha 5 to find five “teenagers with attitude.” Jason, a karate black belt who teaches at the Youth Center, is teleported to the Command Center with Zack, Billy, Trini and Kimberly. They walk away at first, until the Putty Patrol ambushes them and they accept the Power Coins.
- Jason has to turn five very different teenagers into a team while living by Zordon's three rules: never use the Power for personal gain, never escalate a battle, and keep your identity secret. Rita's attacks get bigger: Putties, then Finster's monsters, then Goldar. The Rangers learn to fight as one, call the Dinozords and form the Megazord for the first time.
- **Climax:** Rita throws her wand to Earth and makes her monster grow. With Goldar beside it, it takes Angel Grove apart. Jason leads the first full Megazord battle in Tank Mode and Battle Mode, calls down the Power Sword, and ends it.
- **Ending:** Iron Man ended with “I am Iron Man.” Red Ranger deliberately does the opposite, because canon requires a secret identity. The city cheers for a Red Ranger it can't name, while Jason goes back to teaching karate at the Youth Center. On the Moon, Rita screams, “I have a headache!”

05 • VILLAIN / ANTAGONIST

Rita Repulsa, at full power

- **Main antagonist: Rita Repulsa,** the space witch Zordon imprisoned. She commands from her Moon palace and watches Earth through her telescope. She throws her wand to Earth to make monsters grow (“Magic wand, make my monster grow!”), and every one of those feats is shown at full scale.
- **Her forces: Goldar,** her winged, sword-wielding enforcer, as strong as he is in canon. **Finster,** who sculpts monsters and brings them to life in the Monster-Matic. **Squatt and Baboo,** her bumbling henchmen. And the **Putty Patrol,** her foot soldiers.

06 • POST-CREDITS SCENES

Two scenes

- **Mid-credits: “The Tournament.”** At the Youth Center, Jason spars with a new student, **Tommy Oliver**, and they fight to a draw, as in canon. From the Moon, Rita watches through her telescope, smiles and says, “He’ll be my evil Green Ranger.” This sets up *Green with Evil*.
- **End-credits: “The Watcher.”** Somewhere deep in space, an enormous figure is barely visible in the dark, with only its eyes and silhouette showing. It’s watching Rita’s release and the new Rangers. A deep voice says one word: “**Zordon.**” The figure isn’t named and isn’t credited. Fans will only realize later that they’ve seen **Dark Specter**.

07 • SETTING UP THE BIG BAD

Planting Dark Specter

- **The end-credits scene** is the first, unnamed look at Dark Specter. It’s this saga’s version of the Thanos reveal, and it doesn’t say what it means.
- **Zordon’s time-warp prison is the saga’s spine.** The film makes it clear that Zordon can’t leave his tube, which sets up the vulnerability that Dark Specter exploits at the end of the saga, when he captures and drains Zordon before *Countdown to Destruction*.
- **Rita is the bottom of a hierarchy, not the top.** Small details, like Rita mentioning “powers greater than mine” and shadowy symbols in her palace, hint that the evil Zordon fought 10,000 years ago is part of something bigger. That’s the future United Alliance of Evil.

08 • ITS OWN WORLD-BUILDING

The Mighty Morphin world

- **The Command Center:** Zordon in his time warp, Alpha 5, the Viewing Globe and teleportation.
- **The Power:** Power Morphers and the five Power Coins (Tyrannosaurus, Mastodon, Triceratops, Saber-toothed Tiger, Pterodactyl), the five Power Weapons, the Power Blaster, the Dinozords, and the Megazord in Tank Mode and Battle Mode with the Power Sword.
- **Rita’s side:** the Moon palace, the telescope, the wand that makes monsters grow, the Monster-Matic and the Putty Patrol.
- **Angel Grove life:** the Youth Center gym, Ernie’s Juice Bar and Angel Grove High, with **Bulk and Skull** as the town’s comic relief.

09 • MGU WORLD-BUILDING

The rules every later film builds on

- **The Morphin Grid** is introduced by name. Zordon explains it as the source of every Ranger’s power. It’s the thread that will connect every team, coin, crystal and key in the MGU.
- **Zordon’s three rules** become universe-wide law for every Ranger team that follows.
- **Crossover characters and places that run through the saga:** Zordon, Alpha 5, Bulk and Skull, Ernie, the Youth Center and Angel Grove itself are all introduced here.
- **Earth is a target in a wider cosmic war.** The film establishes that Earth sits in a galaxy with older, larger evils, which leaves room for the Machine Empire, Divatox and Astronema later on.

The Iron Man role

- **It's the first chapter of The Zordon Saga.** Rita's release and Zordon's imprisonment start the story that ends with *Countdown to Destruction*.
- **It proves the formula:** 100% faithful, practical-first filmmaking, full-power heroes and villains, and actors doing their own fights. Its success makes the rest of the MGU possible, the way *Iron Man's* did for Marvel.
- **It starts the secret.** It's marketed as a standalone 20th-anniversary film. Then the two post-credits scenes, Tommy and the unnamed watcher, are the first hints audiences get that this is a universe. Fans work it out on their own, in real time, exactly as the Secrecy Protocol intends.
- **It establishes the leader.** Every future team-up has a Red Ranger at its center, and the first one in the MGU is Jason Lee Scott.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Characters and events follow the original Mighty Morphin Power Rangers series.